

UX/UI audit — researcher portal

First run, fix round, re-run. All on 9 September 2026.

86 screens · 7 journeys · 5 review passes · 38-item best-practice checklist · first run on 73259d4, re-run on daaf308

Morning: **NOT READY** — two blockers. Afternoon: ten fixes merged, re-audited, **READY WITH FIXES**. No blocker open. The one high-priority item left is a design decision, not a defect.

BLOCKERS
2 → 0
sidebar semantics ·
person page

SEVERITY-WEIGHTED
SCORE
93 → 61
target ≤ 60

FINDINGS
43 → 34
16 fixed · 7 new · 0
regressed

BEST PRACTICE / 100
51 → 57
38 items, click-through or
SQL

Before and after

Metric	First run	Re-run	How measured
Findings sev 4 / 3 / 2 / 1	2 / 9 / 26 / 6	0 / 1 / 25 / 8	five review passes, deduplicated, every finding tied to a screenshot
Task success rate	100 %	100 %	7 of 7 runnable journeys, 0 errors
Mean steps per journey	7.9	8.1	tap/input count
Defect density	0.50	0.41	findings per screen
Automated tests	165	183	flutter test
Researchers who can sign in	26 / 184	26 / 184	people.orcid filled — unchanged, the adoption ceiling

The eleven high-priority findings

ID	Finding	Status
F-001	Desktop sidebar absent from the accessibility tree	fixed PR 34 + test
F-002	Person page keeps the previous researcher when only the id changes	fixed PR 36 + test
F-003	Anonymous M2 welcome slug lands on the login wall	fixed PR 36
F-004	Anonymous vs signed-in sidebars differ for the same page	by design recorded
F-005	Reject with no confirmation, reason or feedback	fixed PR 38: dialog, reason, Undo, reason shown to researcher
F-006	404 page prints GoException	fixed PR 36; blank - page regression fixed on daaf308
F-007	25-row researcher sidebar, a third placeholders	open product decision (Rui)
F-008	Sidebar highlights the wrong row	fixed PR 33

ID	Finding	Status
F-009	New output shows no pending tag in My Outputs	fixed PR 32; duplicate-text regression fixed on e5b8847
F-010	Phone dashboard tiles clip	fixed PR 39
F-011	Logo swatch labels illegible	fixed PR 35

Also fixed in the round: sidebar footer overlap, humanised status labels, chooser copy, stale Maestro assertions, phone review tabs and report table.

What is left

Item	Severity	Owner
Sidebar: headers only by default, mark or hide the 8 placeholder leaves	3	Rui — decision, then half a day
Raw status chips on the researcher's profile header (<code>external</code> , <code>pending_review</code>)	2	dev — reuse <code>queueStatusLabel()</code>
Three feedback patterns for one message type	2	dev — pick one
Empty ORCID-sync state for the 158 researchers without an iD	2	dev — explain + link
Thin Personal Information page after the E4 split	2	design
DOI-first Add output + title-similarity warning (BP-07, BP-16)	—	the highest-value feature before the demo

Best practice, 38 items

Met (10)		26 %
Partly met (23)		61 %
Not met (5)		13 %

Ahead of the field for its size: authorship link rows, unique DOI, full audit trail, approval-gated nightly public build, ORCID harvesting, merge tool. Behind: entry starts from a blank form, no draft or withdraw, no reviewer return loop, FCT team export and unclaimed-candidate counts not surfaced.

Method: Playwright crawl of every route in anonymous, researcher and admin mode at 1280 × 900 and 390 × 844; five provoked system states; seven journeys; Nielsen, UX laws, WCAG 2.2, design system vs Figma, five states; ISO 9241-11 metrics; every severity ≥ 3 claim re-tested before inclusion. Full detail: [audit/2026-09-09-1601/report.md](#), research: [docs/research/2026-09-rims-best-practices.md](#), long report: [ux-audit-report.pdf](#). Raw screenshots stay off git (researcher emails).